

whenever you open the workbook.

DATE(year,month,day)

Example:

=DATE(A1,A2,A3)

This combines the values in the arguments into a single cell. Thus if you have the year, month, and date and separate cells, you can use this function to combine it into a single cell and display it in the date format.

	A	B
1	1	45
2	2	12
3	3	12
4	4	December 12, 1945

The date function

DATEVALUE(date_text)

Example: =DATEVALUE(A1) where A1 = '5/12/2006

When you use the apostrophe sign before a number or date, Excel stores the value as text. Normally, you will not be able to perform any of the calculations because it is internally referenced as text. You use the DATEVALUE function to convert the text version of

	A	B
1	5/12/2006	5/12/2006
2	2	39056

The "DATEVALUE" function

the date into an Excel number for the corresponding date. You can then use this number to perform calculations.

DAY(serial_no)

Example: DAY((DATE(07,03,25)))

The serial_no argument returns any day of the month between 1 and 31. In the above example, the DATE function is nested inside the DAY function. Hence, the value returned by the DAY function will be 25, since the DATE function contains the value 2007 for the year, 03 for the month, and 25 for the day.